

Active Shooter and Hostile Event Response (Code Silver)

Policy Number	POL-EM-052	Owner / Department	Security / Emergency Management
Effective Date	2023-06-01	Version	2.0
Last Revised	2026-03-02	Next Review	2028-03-02
Approved By	Emergency Management Committee	Applies To	All staff, licensed providers, students, volunteers, contractors, patients, and visitors, in all areas

1. Purpose

To save lives during an active-shooter or armed/hostile intruder event through the FBI/DHS **Run–Hide–Fight** survival strategy, immediate law-enforcement notification, lockdown, and coordination through the Hospital Incident Command System, consistent with The Joint Commission Emergency Management standards and OSHA workplace-violence guidance.

2. Scope

Applies to any event involving an active shooter, a person brandishing or threatening with a weapon, or an armed hostile intruder anywhere on the campus. Individual survival actions take precedence; staff are not expected to confront an armed assailant.

3. Definitions

- **Code Silver** — the overhead alert for an active shooter or person with a weapon, followed by location.
- **Run (Avoid)** — evacuate away from the threat if there is an accessible escape path.
- **Hide (Deny)** — if escape is not possible, shelter out of view behind a locked/barricaded door, silence phones, and stay quiet.
- **Fight (Defend)** — as a last resort when life is in imminent danger, act with aggression to incapacitate the attacker.
- **Lockdown** — securing units and the facility to deny the attacker access and movement.

4. Procedure — Run, Hide, Fight

IMPORTANT — Run · Hide · Fight. **RUN:** if there is a safe escape path, leave belongings and get out, keeping hands visible for responding officers. **HIDE:** if you cannot escape, lock/barricade the door, turn off lights, silence phones, and stay out of sight. **FIGHT:** only as a last resort to save your life. Call 911 and the facility emergency number to announce Code Silver with the location as soon as it is safe.

1. **Run.** If there is an accessible escape route, evacuate immediately; leave belongings behind, help others if possible, and keep hands empty and visible.

2. **Hide.** If you cannot escape, move out of the attacker's view; lock and barricade the door with heavy furniture; turn off lights; silence all devices; remain quiet.
3. **Fight.** As a last resort and only when your life is in imminent danger, commit to disrupting or incapacitating the attacker using improvised weapons and aggression.
4. **Notify.** Call 911 and the facility emergency number when safe; report location, number of shooters, description, and weapons. Initiate lockdown of your area.
5. **On law-enforcement arrival.** Remain calm, keep hands visible and empty, follow all commands, and do not run toward or grab officers; they will move to the threat first, not to the injured.

5. Severity & Reporting

An active-shooter or armed-intruder event is a **SEV-1** catastrophic event under POL-RM-013. Notify law enforcement (911) and Security **immediately**; notify the Administrator-on-Call and Safety Officer within 1 hour; activate HICS. A casualty surge from the event is managed concurrently under POL-EM-053 (Code Triage). A credible weapon threat without discharge, or a weapon recovered without injury, is at least **SEV-2** and still reported. File an event report once the scene is secure; preserve the scene for law enforcement and do not disturb evidence.

6. Documentation Requirements

- Location, time, and how the threat was identified.
- Description of the assailant(s), weapon(s), and direction of travel as reported.
- Areas locked down, evacuated, or sheltered; staff and patient accounting.
- Injuries and casualties; law-enforcement and EMS response times.
- HICS activation and all notifications (who, when, by what method).

7. References

- FBI, Active Shooter Resources; DHS/CISA, Run–Hide–Fight active-shooter guidance.
- The Joint Commission, Emergency Management (EM) and workplace-violence requirements.
- OSHA, workplace-violence prevention for healthcare (General Duty Clause, Publication 3148).
- Related: POL-RM-013 (severity & reporting), POL-EM-053 (Code Triage / HICS), POL-EM-056 (bomb threat), POL-EH-011 (workplace violence).